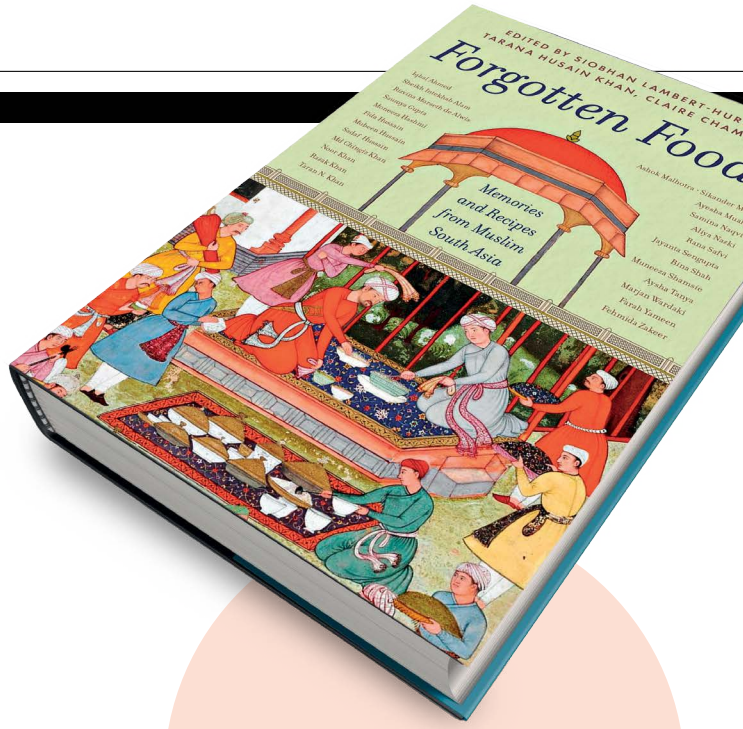
BOOKS

What the Palate Remembers

A collection of essays on South Asian Muslim food seasoned with a sprinkling of promising recipes



FORGOTTEN FOODS
Memories and Recipes from Muslim South Asia
Edited by Siobhan Lambert-Hurley, Tarana Husain Khan and Claire Chambers
PICADOR INDIA
₹499; 328 pages

As we learn from the preface, *Forgotten Foods* is an anthology of essays, anecdotes and meditations on South Asian Muslim food and one that is generously garnished with recipes. Indeed, the best aspect of the book is that along with the rich information and histories it lays out, it also doubles as a no-nonsense cookbook. The book grew as one offshoot of a research and public engagement project entitled 'Forgotten Food: Culinary Memories, Local Heritage and Lost Agricultural Varieties in India'. This volume follows *Desi Delicacies*

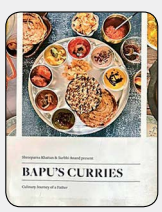


COMFORT & JOY
Irresistible Pleasures from a Vegetarian Kitchen
by Ravinder Bhogal
BLOOMSBURY
₹1,299; 272 pages

This ode to cooking with vegetables harks back to Bhogal's Edenic childhood in Nairobi where her beloved Bhaji (grandfather), who had migrated to Kenya from Punjab, had tended a barren plot of land into a thriving vegetable patch. Cut to the present and Bhogal runs Jikoni, a much-feted restaurant in London, inspired by immigrant cuisine and "cooking without borders". The recipes in this book certainly have the chef's flourish, like Saffron Malpuas. Some have quirk, like KFC, which is actually Korean Fried Cauliflower! Thankfully, while choosing to celebrate vegetarian cuisine, Bhogal steers away from demonising our carnivorous instincts.

Everyone who thinks Marwari food is boring should buy this book immediately. *Bapu's Curries* is a culinary tribute to Shreeparna Khaitan's father, Umesh Khaitan, a lawyer by profession and cook by passion. For a self-published book, it has been superbly executed, although they did have professional help from culinary consultant Sangeeta Khanna. Here you will discover heartwarming culinary delights like *chutki wali roti*, *anar ke ras wale alu*, *santare ka jhol*, besides classics like *gattey ka saag*. The Marwari penchant for fruit curries gets them their own section. Heirloom recipes, dal and wedding dishes are other notable sections.

BAPU'S CURRIES
Culinary Journey of a Father
by Shreeparna Khaitan & Surbhi Anand
SELF-PUBLISHED
₹1,999; 224 pages



BOOKLIST

FOOD FOR THOUGHT

Indian cookbooks—with a delicious twist